

(*To VIOLA.*)

Your master quits you; and for your service done him,
So much against the mettle of your sex,
So far beneath your soft and tender breeding,
And since you call'd me 'master' for so long,
Here is my hand: you shall from this time be
Your master's mistress.

OLIVIA

(*To VIOLA*)

A sister! you are she.

(*Re-enter FABIAN, with MALVOLIO.*)

ORSINO

Is this the madman?

OLIVIA

Ay, my lord, this same.

How now, Malvolio?

MALVOLIO

Madam, you have done me wrong,

Notorious wrong.

OLIVIA

Have I, Malvolio? no.

MALVOLIO

(*Handing her a paper*)

Lady, you have. Pray you, peruse that letter.
You must not now deny it is your hand:
Write from it, if you can, in hand or phrase;
Or say 'tis not your seal, nor your invention:
You can say none of this: well, grant it then
And tell me, in the modesty of honour,
Why you have given me such clear lights of favour,
Bade me come smiling and cross-garter'd to you,
To put on yellow stockings and to frown

Upon Sir Toby and the lighter people;
And, acting this in an obedient hope,
Why have you suffer'd me to be imprison'd,
Kept in a dark house, visited by the priest,
And made the most notorious geck and gull
That e'er invention play'd on? tell me why.

OLIVIA

Alas, Malvolio, this is not my writing,
Though, I confess, much like the character
But out of question 'tis Maria's hand.
And now I do bethink me, it was she
First told me thou wast mad; then earnest in smiling,
And in such forms which here were presupposed
Upon thee in the letter. Prithce, be content:
This practise hath most shrewdly pass'd upon thee;
But when we know the grounds and authors of it,
Thou shalt be both the plaintiff and the judge
Of thine own cause.

FABIAN

Good madam, hear me speak,
And let no quarrel nor no brawl to come
Taint the condition of this present hour,
Which I have wonder'd at. In hope it shall not,
Most freely I confess, myself and Toby
Set this device against Malvolio here,
Upon some stubborn and uncourteous parts
We had conceived against him: Maria writ
The letter at Sir Toby's great importance;
In recompense whereof he hath married her.
How with a sportful malice it was follow'd,
May rather pluck on laughter than revenge;
If that the injuries be justly weigh'd
That have on both sides pass'd.

OLIVIA

(To FABIAN)

Read it you, sirrah.

(She gives the letter to FABIAN.)

FABIAN

(Reads)

'By the Lord, madam, you wrong me, and the world shall know it: though you have put me into darkness and given your drunken cousin rule over me, yet have I the benefit of my senses as well as your ladyship. I have your own letter that induced me to the semblance I put on; with the which I doubt not but to do myself much right, or you much shame. Think of me as you please. I leave my duty a little unthought of and speak out of my injury.—The madly-used Malvolio.'

OLIVIA

Did he write this?

FESTE

Ay, madam.

ORSINO

This savours not much of distraction.

OLIVIA

See him deliver'd, Fabian; bring him hither.

(Exit FABIAN.)

(To ORSINO.)

My lord, so please you, these things further thought on,
To think me as well a sister as a wife,
One day shall crown the alliance on't, so please you,
Here at my house and at my proper cost.

ORSINO

Madam, I am most apt to embrace your offer.



'GOOD MADAM, HEAR ME SPEAK'

OLIVIA

He shall enlarge him: fetch Malvolio hither:
And yet, alas, now I remember me,
They say, poor gentleman, he's much distract.

(*Re-enter FESTE, with a letter; and FABIAN.*)

A most extracting frenzy of mine own
From my remembrance clearly banish'd his.

(*To FESTE*)

How does he, sirrah?

FESTE

Truly, madam, he holds Belzebub at the staves' end as well as a man
in his case may do: has here writ a letter to you; I should have
given't you to-day morning, but as a madman's epistles are no
gospels, so it skills not much when they are delivered.

OLIVIA

Open't, and read it.

FESTE

Look then to be well edified when the fool delivers the madman.

(*Reads*)

'By the Lord, madam,—

OLIVIA

How now! art thou mad?

FESTE

No, madam, I do but read madness: an your ladyship will have it as
it ought to be, you must allow *vox*.

OLIVIA

Prithce, read i' thy right wits.

FESTE

So I do, madonna; but to read his right wits is to read thus:
therefore perpend, my princess, and give ear.

OLIVIA

(*To MALVOLIO*)

Alas, poor fool, how have they baffled thee!

FESTE

Why, 'some are born great, some achieve greatness, and some have
greatness thrown upon them.' I was one, sir, in this interlude; one
Sir Topas, sir; but that's all one. 'By the Lord, fool, I am not mad.'
But do you remember? 'Madam, why laugh you at such a barren
rascal? an you smile not, he's gagged?' and thus the whittling of
time brings in his revenges.

MALVOLIO

I'll be revenged on the whole pack of you.

(*Exit MALVOLIO.*)

OLIVIA

He hath been most notoriously abused.

ORSINO

Pursue him and entreat him to a peace:
He hath not told us of the captain yet:
When that is known and golden time convents,
A solemn combination shall be made
Of our dear souls. Meantime, sweet sister,
We will not part from hence. Cesario, come;
For so you shall be, while you are a man;
But when in other habits you are seen,
Orsino's mistress and his fancy's queen.

(*Exit all, except FESTE.*)

FESTE

(*Sings*)

*When that I was and a little tiny boy,
With bey, bo, the wind and the rain,
A foolish thing was but a toy,
For the rain it raineth every day.*

All the occurrence of my fortune since
Hath been between this lady and this lord.

SEBASTIAN

(*To OLIVIA*)

So comes it, lady, you have been mistook:
But nature to her bias drew in that.
You would have been contracted to a maid;
Nor are you therein, by my life, deceived,
You are betroth'd both to a maid and man.

ORSINO

(*To OLIVIA*)

Be not amazed; right noble is his blood.
If this be so, as yet the glass seems true,
I shall have share in this most happy wreck.

(*To VIOLA*)

Boy, thou hast said to me a thousand times
Thou never shouldst love woman like to me.

VIOLA

And all those sayings will I overswear;
And those swearings keep as true in soul
As doth that orb'd continent the fire
That severs day from night.

ORSINO

Give me thy hand;
And let me see thee in thy woman's weeds.

VIOLA

The captain that did bring me first on shore
Hath my maid's garments: he upon some action
Is now in durance, at Malvolio's suit,
A gentleman, and follower of my lady's.



'FOR THE RAIN IT RAINETH EVERY DAY'

VIOLA

Of Messaline: Sebastian was my father;
Such a Sebastian was my brother too,
So went he suited to his watery tomb:
If spirits can assume both form and suit
You come to fright us.

SEBASTIAN

A spirit I am indeed;
But am in that dimension grossly clad
Which from the womb I did participate.
Were you a woman, as the rest goes even,
I should my tears let fall upon your cheek,
And say 'Thrice-welcome, drowned Viola!'

VIOLA

My father had a mole upon his brow.

SEBASTIAN

And so had mine.

VIOLA

And died that day when Viola from her birth
Had number'd thirteen years.

SEBASTIAN

O, that record is lively in my soul!
He finish'd indeed his mortal act
That day that made my sister thirteen years.

VIOLA

If nothing lets to make us happy both
But this my masculine usurp'd attire,
Do not embrace me till each circumstance
Of place, time, fortune, do cohere and jump
That I am Viola: which to confirm,
I'll bring you to a captain in this town,
Where lie my maiden weeds; by whose gentle help
I was preserved to serve this noble count.

*But when I came to man's estate,
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,
'Gainst knaves and thieves men shut their gate,
For the rain it raineth every day.*

*But when I came, alas! to wive,
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,
By swaggering could I never thrive,
For the rain it raineth every day.*

*But when I came unto my beds,
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,
With toss-pots still had drunken heads,
For the rain it raineth every day.*

*A great while ago the world begun,
With hey, ho, the wind and the rain,
But that's all one, our play is done,
And we'll strive to please you every day.*

(Exeunt omnes.)



Colophon

The first documented public performance of *Twelfth Night* was on 2 February 1602. Twelfth Night—the night before Epiphany (6 January), or the twelfth night after Christmas—was, in Elizabethan times, a festival of licensed disorder presided over by a ‘Lord of Misrule’, so William Shakespeare’s (1564–1616) merry comedy of mistaken identities would have been suitably ‘topsy-turvy’ entertainment. *Twelfth Night* was first published by William Jaggard in London, in 1623, as part of *Mr. William Shakespeare’s Comedies, Histories, & Tragedies: Published according to the True and Original Copies: the ‘First Folio’*.

Illustrations by British artist William Heath Robinson (1872–1944) are from a 1913 edition published by Hodder & Stoughton in London (UK).

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I do perceive it hath offended you:
 Pardon me, sweet one, even for the vows
 We made each other but so late ago.

ORSINO

One face, one voice, one habit, and two persons,
 A natural perspective, that is and is not!

SEBASTIAN

Antonio, O my dear Antonio!
 How have the hours rack’d and tortured me,
 Since I have lost thee!

ANTONIO

Sebastian are you?

SEBASTIAN

Fear’st thou that, Antonio?

ANTONIO

How have you made division of yourself?
 An apple, cleft in two, is not more twin
 Than these two creatures. Which is Sebastian?

OLIVIA

Most wonderful!

SEBASTIAN

(*Looking at VIOLA*)

Do I stand there? I never had a brother;
 Nor can there be that deity in my nature,
 Of here and every where. I had a sister,
 Whom the blind waves and surges have devour’d.
 Of charity, what kin are you to me?
 What countryman? what name? what parentage?